

» RABBITS AND HARES

37–40 cm
14½–16 in



DESERT COTTONTAIL

Sylvilagus audubonii

Found in arid regions of S.W. USA and N. and C. Mexico, the desert cottontail nests above ground rather than in a burrow.



MARSH RABBIT

Sylvilagus palustris

Inhabiting wetlands of

N. America, this species is a strong swimmer. It walks instead of hopping, unlike most of its relatives.

42–44 cm
16½–17½ in



56–66 cm
22–26 in

WHITE-TAILED JACKRABBIT

Lepus townsendii

This species ranges extensively across western N. America. The northern population turns white in winter, while the southern animals develop whitish patches only on their flanks.

52–61 cm
20½–24 in

BLACK-TAILED JACKRABBIT

Lepus californicus

Widespread on western N. American prairies and farmland, this species is prone to huge local fluctuations. It has a black tail and black ear-tips.



long
legs



55–67 cm
22–26 in

ANTELOPE JACKRABBIT

Lepus alleni

Very long ears and insulated, reflective fur help this large hare to keep cool in its desert grassland habitats in Mexico.



36–52 cm
14–20½ in

SNOWSHOE HARE

Lepus americanus

Adapted to harsh N. American winters, this species has a white winter coat for camouflage, and large hind feet to allow movement on soft snow.



55–70 cm
22–28 in

ARCTIC HARE

Lepus arcticus

Adapted to polar and mountainous areas, this hare survives with thick fur that turns white in winter, and by digging snow holes for shelter.

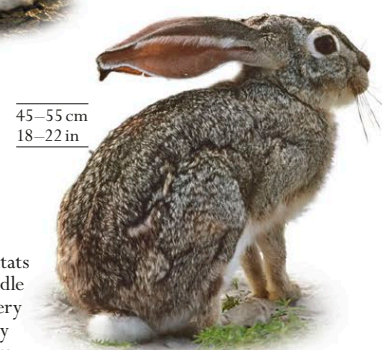


51–55 cm
20–22 in

MOUNTAIN HARE

Lepus timidus

From polar regions and mountains in Europe and Asia, this hare has a white winter coat and a tail that stays white all year round.



45–55 cm
18–22 in

CAPE HARE

Lepus capensis

Common in open habitats of Africa and the Middle East, this species is very similar to the closely related European hare.

PIKAS

The Ochotonidae are small herbivores that live in rocky mountain sides and open steppes in North America and Asia. Alert to predators, they produce high-pitched alarm calls as they run for cover in crevices and burrows.



16–21 cm
6½–8½ in

AMERICAN PIKA

Ochotona princeps

This N. American montane scree dweller dries food piles in the sun, and stores them in its den for the winter.

brown fur, sometimes
turns reddish

long, black-tipped ears

50–70 cm
20–28 in

powerful hind legs